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(AI-Generated Session Notes)

From Process to Prompt to Automation: How a Marketing Job becomes a Marketing Tool

Date & time: Oct. 14, 3:05-3:40 PM EST
Track: Applied AI



Andy Crestodina

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Session Description

What happens when marketers stop thinking of AI as a tool for isolated tasks and start using it to rethink how work actually gets done? In this session, Andy Crestodina, Co-Founder and CMO of Orbit Media, explores how a marketing process can evolve into a prompt-driven prototype for smarter execution.

Through examples, insights, and real-world experimentation, Crestodina will share how marketing teams can identify repeatable work, reimagine it with AI, and uncover new opportunities to build tools that extend human expertise. Attendees will leave with actionable ideas and a broader perspective on how AI can help transform marketing jobs into scalable, useful systems.

Key Quote

> *"The only people who think this is hard are the people who really haven't tried to do it yet."* **- Andy Crestodina**

Session Summary

Andy Crestodina, co-founder and CMO of Orbit Media, walked attendees through the next step in what he called the evolution of the marketer: moving from prompts, to assistants such as Claude projects, Gemini gems and Copilot agents, to fully built tools. Describing himself as a marketer with no technical skills who has never written code, he showed how AI now lets non-engineers build working tools simply by describing what they want, defining goals, users, inputs, specs and outputs up front.

His centerpiece example was a CRO bot that takes a URL, builds a buyer persona, audits the page through that buyer's eyes, creates a wireframe and visual hierarchy, extracts the site's design standards and mocks up an improved page. He was candid about its limits: the output had no verified copy, final images or real evidence, and wasn't connected to a CMS, analytics or accessibility checks. Its value, he said, is as a good hypothesis for buyer alignment that a conversion copywriter can build from.

Crestodina focused his other examples on bridging marketing and sales: a buyer signals monitor that ingests sales call transcripts to surface themes and technology trends in the buyer's own words, a lead enricher built in Clay that pushes detailed lead intelligence into Slack, and a sales coach trained on past calls that lets reps practice conversations with real leads and AI personas, then scores their performance.

He urged attendees to have a conversation with AI about what to build rather than micromanaging it, citing the bitter lesson and recommending prompts like “What should we do next?” He also cautioned against one-shotting things and rushing to show off new builds. A build report on his sales coach showed seven hours of work and 62 prompts, with about a third of the time spent on strategy and direction and 51% spent waiting.

He closed by stressing that domain expertise, judgment and good architecture matter more than ever. Tools should draw from shared data lakes to avoid tool sprawl and shelfware, and process plus tools equals a system. For Crestodina, building something that makes things is still creative work, and the measure that matters is outcomes, not outputs.

Key Takeaways

- **Anyone can build tools now.** Crestodina built working marketing and sales tools with no coding background by clearly describing goals, users, inputs, specs and outputs.
- **Ask AI what to build, not just how.** Open-ended prompts like “What should we do next?” and “What would make this way more useful?” let AI improve on ideas you wouldn't have thought of yourself.
- **Good tools take real work.** His sales coach took seven hours and 62 prompts, so aim to build great things rather than celebrating what you can one-shot.
- **Use AI to bridge marketing and sales.** Tools that monitor buyer signals in call transcripts, enrich leads and coach reps help marketers drive pipeline revenue instead of tossing leads over a wall.
- **Plan the architecture first.** Have tools pull from shared, connected data sources so you avoid tool sprawl, shelfware and a “Frankenstack.”
- **Focus on outcomes, not outputs.** Process plus tools equals a system, and the goal of building that system is measurable business results.